



SRI RAMACHANDRA

INSTITUTE OF HIGHER EDUCATION AND RESEARCH

(Category - I Deemed to be University) Porur, Chennai

SRI RAMACHANDRA FACULTY OF ENGINEERING AND TECHNOLOGY

AIR QUALITY INDEX (AQI) PREDICTION USING DEEP LEARNING WITH SEASONAL DECOMPOSITION

CDS23CL302 – EXPLORATORY DATA ANALYSIS

PROJECT REPORT

Submitted by

ROKESH G – E6223006

In partial fulfilment for the award of the degree of

BACHELOR OF SCIENCE

in

COMPUTER SCIENCE

(DATA SCIENCE)

Sri Ramachandra Faculty of Engineering and Technology

Sri Ramachandra Institute of Higher Education and Research, Porur, Chennai -600116

April, 2026



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BONAFIDE CERTIFICATE

Certified that this project report **“Air Quality Index (AQI) Prediction Using Deep Learning With Seasonal Decomposition”** is the Bonafide record of work done by **“ROKESH G – E6223006”** who carried out the internship work under my supervision.

Signature of the Supervisor

Prof. S. Deena

Assistant Professor,

Department of Artificial Intelligence and

Analytics, Sri Ramachandra Faculty of

Engineering and Technology,

SRIHER,

Porur, Chennai – 600 116

Evaluation Date:

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

CHAPTER NO.	TITLE	PAGE NO.
	LIST OF FIGURES	1
	ABSTRACT	2
1	INTRODUCTION	3
	1.1 Background of the Study	3
	1.2 Problem Statement	3
	1.3 Objectives of the Study	4
	1.4 Scope and Limitations	4
	1.5 Significance of the Study	5
	1.6 Organization of the Report	5
2	LITERATURE REVIEW	6
	2.1 Introduction to the Literature	6
	2.2 Related Work	6
3	PROPOSED METHODOLOGY	8
	3.1 Introduction	8
	3.2 Proposed System/Methodology	8
	3.3 Module Description	10
	3.3.1 Algorithms / Models Used	11
	3.3.2 Evaluation Metrics	13
	3.4 Summary	13
4	SYSTEM IMPLEMENTATION	15
	4.1 Introduction	15
	4.2 Hardware and Software Specifications	15
	4.2.1 Tools / Libraries Used	15
	4.3 Implementation Details	16
	4.3.1 Dataset Collection and Description	19
	4.4 Summary	20

5	SOURCE CODE	21
	5.1 Experimental Result / Code	21
	5.2 Visualization of Results / Output	23
	5.3 Interpretation and Analysis	23
	5.4 Discussion of Key Findings	24
	5.5 Limitations of Results	24
6	CONCLUSION AND FUTURE WORK	27
	6.1 Summary of the Research	27
	6.2 Conclusion Drawn from the Results	27
	6.3 Contributions of the Study	28
	6.4 Future Work	28
	REFERENCES	29

LIST OF FIGURES

Fig. No.	Fig. Name	Page No.
1	Figure 1: System Architecture	14
2	Figure 2: Dataset Shape	25
3	Figure 3: Missing Values	25
4	Figure 4: Sample Output of Time Series Decomposition Displaying Trend, Seasonal, and Residual Values	25
5	Figure 5: Model Evaluation Metrics Results	26
6	Figure 6: Actual Model Performance (R^2 and MAE)	26
7	Figure 7: Missing Values per Pollutant (Before Imputation)	26

ABSTRACT

Air pollution is one of the most serious environmental and public health concerns worldwide. Accurate prediction of the Air Quality Index (AQI) is essential for effective environmental monitoring, early warning systems, and policy planning. This project proposes a deep learning-based AQI forecasting model using historical pollutant concentration data collected from multiple cities.

The study incorporates advanced data preprocessing techniques, including multi-level missing value imputation and K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN) imputation, to handle incomplete real-world datasets. To improve time-series prediction performance, Seasonal-Trend decomposition using LOESS (STL) is applied to extract trend, seasonal, and residual components of AQI, which are used as additional predictive features. A sequence modeling approach is implemented using a Gated Recurrent Unit (GRU) neural network to capture temporal dependencies in pollution patterns. The model utilizes a 30-day sliding window mechanism to forecast future AQI values.

Model performance is evaluated using multiple regression metrics such as R^2 Score, Mean Absolute Error (MAE), Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE), and Mean Absolute Percentage Error (MAPE). Experimental results demonstrate that the proposed model effectively captures seasonal variations and long-term trends, achieving high predictive accuracy. The developed system can assist environmental agencies and smart city initiatives in proactive air quality management and public health protection.

Keywords:

Air Quality Index (AQI), Deep Learning, GRU, Time-Series Forecasting, Seasonal Decomposition (STL), KNN Imputation, Environmental Monitoring, Air Pollution Prediction.

1. INTRODUCTION

Air pollution has emerged as one of the most critical environmental challenges affecting human health, climate change, and sustainable development. Rapid industrialization, urbanization, vehicular emissions, and population growth have significantly contributed to deteriorating air quality levels across major cities. The Air Quality Index (AQI) is a standardized indicator used to measure and communicate the level of air pollution and its potential impact on public health. Accurate prediction of AQI enables authorities to implement timely preventive measures and helps citizens make informed decisions regarding their daily activities.

With the advancement of Artificial Intelligence and Deep Learning techniques, time-series forecasting of environmental data has become more efficient and accurate. This study focuses on developing a deep learning-based AQI prediction model using historical pollutant data, seasonal decomposition techniques, and sequence modeling approaches.

1.1 Background of the Study

Air pollution consists of harmful substances such as particulate matter (PM_{2.5}, PM₁₀), nitrogen oxides (NO, NO₂), sulfur dioxide (SO₂), carbon monoxide (CO), ozone (O₃), and other toxic gases. These pollutants directly impact respiratory health, cardiovascular systems, and overall public well-being.

Traditional statistical models have been used for air quality forecasting; however, they often fail to capture complex nonlinear relationships and seasonal patterns present in environmental data. Deep learning models, especially recurrent neural networks such as GRU and LSTM, are capable of learning temporal dependencies and nonlinear relationships effectively.

In this project, advanced preprocessing methods such as multi-level missing value imputation and Seasonal-Trend decomposition (STL) are integrated with a GRU-based neural network to improve AQI prediction accuracy.

1.2 Problem Statement

Air quality datasets collected from multiple cities often contain:

- Missing values
- Seasonal variations
- Nonlinear relationships between pollutants
- High variability over time

Traditional forecasting techniques struggle to handle these complexities effectively. Therefore, there is a need for a robust deep learning-based framework that:

- Handles missing and incomplete environmental data

- Extracts seasonal and trend components
- Captures long-term temporal dependencies
- Provides accurate AQI predictions

This study aims to address these challenges by developing an efficient time-series deep learning model for AQI forecasting.

1.3 Objectives of the Study

The main objectives of this study are:

1. To perform data preprocessing and handle missing pollutant values using advanced imputation techniques.
2. To apply Seasonal-Trend decomposition (STL) to extract meaningful components from AQI data.
3. To construct a time-series dataset using sliding window sequence modeling.
4. To develop a GRU-based deep learning model for AQI prediction.
5. To evaluate model performance using multiple regression metrics such as R^2 , MAE, RMSE, and MAPE.
6. To analyze the effectiveness of seasonal decomposition in improving prediction accuracy.

1.4 Scope and Limitations

Scope

- The study focuses on multi-city AQI prediction using historical pollutant concentration data.
- Deep learning techniques are used for time-series forecasting.
- Seasonal decomposition is integrated to enhance prediction performance.
- The framework can be extended for real-time AQI monitoring systems.

Limitations

- Meteorological factors such as temperature, humidity, and wind speed are not included.
- The model is trained only on historical pollutant data.
- Hyperparameter tuning is limited due to computational constraints.

- Real-time deployment is not implemented in this project.

1.5 Significance of the Study

This study is significant because:

- It improves AQI prediction accuracy using deep learning techniques.
- It integrates seasonal decomposition for enhanced time-series modeling.
- It provides a scalable framework for multi-city pollution forecasting.
- It supports environmental agencies in decision-making.
- It contributes to smart city initiatives and public health protection.

Accurate AQI forecasting can help reduce health risks, guide pollution control measures, and improve environmental sustainability.

1.6 Organization of the Report

The report is organized as follows:

- **Chapter 1:** Introduction – Overview, objectives, scope, and significance of the study.
- **Chapter 2:** Literature Review – Review of existing AQI prediction models and related research.
- **Chapter 3:** Methodology – Data preprocessing, seasonal decomposition, and model development.
- **Chapter 4:** Experimental Results and Analysis – Model training, evaluation metrics, and performance analysis.
- **Chapter 5:** Conclusion and Future Work – Summary of findings and possible future enhancements.

2. LITERATURE REVIEW

2.1 Introduction to the Literature

Air Quality Index (AQI) prediction has gained significant research attention due to increasing air pollution levels worldwide. Accurate forecasting of air pollution helps governments, environmental agencies, and public health organizations implement preventive strategies. Over the years, researchers have explored various statistical, machine learning, and deep learning approaches for air quality prediction.

Traditional statistical methods such as linear regression, autoregressive integrated moving average (ARIMA), and multiple regression models were initially used for pollution forecasting. However, these models often struggle to capture nonlinear relationships and complex seasonal variations in environmental data.

With advancements in Artificial Intelligence (AI), machine learning techniques such as Support Vector Machines (SVM), Random Forest, Decision Trees, and Gradient Boosting have been widely applied to AQI prediction. These models improved prediction accuracy compared to classical statistical approaches. However, they still face limitations in modeling long-term temporal dependencies.

Recently, deep learning techniques, particularly Recurrent Neural Networks (RNN), Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM), and Gated Recurrent Unit (GRU), have demonstrated superior performance in time-series forecasting problems. These models effectively capture sequential dependencies and nonlinear patterns in air pollution data.

In addition, researchers have emphasized the importance of proper data preprocessing, missing value imputation, feature engineering, and seasonal decomposition to enhance forecasting performance. This chapter reviews relevant studies related to AQI prediction and identifies research gaps addressed in the present work.

2.2 Related Work

Several studies have explored different approaches for AQI and air pollution forecasting.

Early research focused on statistical time-series models such as ARIMA for predicting pollutant concentrations. Although ARIMA models performed reasonably well for short-term forecasting, they required stationary data and were limited in handling nonlinear variations.

Machine learning approaches later gained popularity. Studies using Support Vector Regression (SVR) demonstrated improved performance in modeling nonlinear relationships between pollutants and AQI. Random Forest and Gradient Boosting algorithms were also used due to their robustness and ability to handle high-dimensional data. These models showed better generalization compared to traditional regression techniques.

With the emergence of deep learning, researchers began applying Recurrent Neural Networks (RNN) for sequential air quality data. However, basic RNN models suffered from vanishing gradient problems when learning long-term dependencies.

To overcome this limitation, Long Short-Term Memory (LSTM) networks were introduced and widely adopted for AQI prediction. LSTM models effectively captured long-term temporal dependencies and seasonal patterns in pollution data. Several studies reported significant improvements in R^2 score and reduced error metrics using LSTM-based forecasting models.

More recently, Gated Recurrent Unit (GRU) networks have been proposed as a computationally efficient alternative to LSTM. GRU models require fewer parameters while maintaining strong performance in time-series prediction tasks. Many comparative studies indicate that GRU achieves similar or better accuracy than LSTM with reduced training time.

Additionally, hybrid models combining statistical decomposition techniques such as Seasonal-Trend decomposition using LOESS (STL) with deep learning architectures have shown improved forecasting accuracy. By separating trend and seasonal components before model training, these approaches enhance model interpretability and prediction performance.

Despite these advancements, several research gaps remain:

- Inadequate handling of missing pollutant data
- Limited integration of seasonal decomposition with deep learning
- Insufficient multi-city modeling frameworks
- High computational complexity in transformer-based models

The present study addresses these gaps by integrating:

- Multi-level missing value imputation
- KNN-based data completion
- Seasonal-Trend decomposition (STL)
- GRU-based sequence modeling

This integrated approach improves AQI prediction accuracy while maintaining computational efficiency.

3. PROPOSED METHODOLOGY

3.1 Introduction

This chapter describes the proposed deep learning-based framework for Air Quality Index (AQI) prediction. The methodology integrates advanced data preprocessing, seasonal decomposition, sequence modeling, and a GRU-based neural network for time-series forecasting.

The objective of the proposed system is to improve AQI prediction accuracy by:

- Handling missing pollutant values effectively
- Capturing seasonal and trend patterns
- Modeling temporal dependencies using deep learning
- Evaluating performance using multiple regression metrics

The overall system follows a structured pipeline beginning with data preprocessing and ending with model evaluation.

3.2 Proposed System / Methodology

The proposed system consists of the following major stages:

Step 1: Data Collection

The dataset contains daily pollutant concentration data from multiple cities, including PM_{2.5}, PM₁₀, NO₂, SO₂, CO, O₃, and other pollutants along with AQI values.

Step 2: Data Preprocessing

Real-world environmental datasets contain missing values and irregular patterns. A multi-level imputation strategy is applied:

1. Linear interpolation (time-based)
2. Rolling mean smoothing (7-day window)
3. Monthly seasonal mean filling

4. K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN) imputation

This ensures complete and reliable input data for model training.

Step 3: Seasonal Decomposition (STL)

To enhance time-series learning, Seasonal-Trend decomposition using LOESS (STL) is applied to AQI:

$$\text{AQI}(t) = \text{Trend}(t) + \text{Seasonal}(t) + \text{Residual}(t)$$

Where:

- Trend(t) represents long-term variation
- Seasonal(t) captures repeating seasonal patterns
- Residual(t) represents noise

These components are added as additional input features to improve model performance.

Step 4: Feature Engineering

Input Features:

- 12 pollutant concentration variables
- Trend component
- Seasonal component
- Residual component

Target Variable:

- AQI

All features are normalized using MinMax Scaling to ensure stable neural network training.

Step 5: Sequence Creation

Since AQI forecasting is a time-series problem:

- A 30-day sliding window is used

- The model predicts the next day's AQI

This transforms the dataset into a 3D structure:

Samples $\times$ Time Steps $\times$ Features

Step 6: Model Development

A Gated Recurrent Unit (GRU) network is implemented to capture temporal dependencies efficiently.

Architecture:

Input Layer $\rightarrow$ GRU Layer $\rightarrow$ Fully Connected Layer $\rightarrow$ Output (Predicted AQI)

Step 7: Model Training

- Loss Function: Mean Squared Error (MSE)
- Optimizer: Adam
- Learning Rate: 0.001
- Batch Size: 512
- Epochs: 25

Gradient clipping is applied to prevent exploding gradients.

Step 8: Model Evaluation

Predictions are converted back to original AQI scale and evaluated using multiple performance metrics.

3.3 Module Description

The system is divided into the following modules:

Module 1: Data Preprocessing Module

- Date formatting
- Sorting by city and time

- Missing value handling
- Data normalization

Module 2: Seasonal Decomposition Module

- STL decomposition
- Extraction of trend, seasonal, residual components

Module 3: Sequence Generator Module

- Sliding window creation
- Multi-city sequence merging

Module 4: Model Training Module

- GRU architecture implementation
- Forward and backward propagation
- Loss optimization

Module 5: Evaluation Module

- Prediction generation
- Error metric computation
- Performance analysis

3.3.1 Algorithms / Models Used

1. K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN) Imputation

Used to fill remaining missing values by identifying similar data points.

2. Seasonal-Trend Decomposition (STL)

Used to separate AQI into trend and seasonal components.

Mathematical representation:

$$AQI(t) = T(t) + S(t) + R(t)$$

Where:

$T(t)$ = Trend

$S(t)$ = Seasonal component

$R(t)$ = Residual component

3. Gated Recurrent Unit (GRU)

GRU is a type of recurrent neural network designed to capture temporal dependencies efficiently.

GRU contains:

- Update Gate
- Reset Gate

Update Gate Equation:

$$z_t = \sigma(W_z \cdot [h_{t-1}, x_t])$$

Reset Gate Equation:

$$r_t = \sigma(W_r \cdot [h_{t-1}, x_t])$$

Hidden State:

$$h_t = (1 - z_t) \odot h_{t-1} + z_t \odot \tanh(W \cdot [r_t \odot h_{t-1}, x_t])$$

Where:

- σ = Sigmoid function
- $\odot$ = Element-wise multiplication
- x_t = Input at time t
- h_t = Hidden state

GRU is chosen because:

- Fewer parameters than LSTM
- Faster training

- Effective for sequential data

3.3.2 Evaluation Metrics

To measure model performance, the following regression metrics are used:

1. Mean Absolute Error (MAE)

$$\text{MAE} = (1/n) \sum |y_i - \hat{y}_i|$$

2. Mean Squared Error (MSE)

$$\text{MSE} = (1/n) \sum (y_i - \hat{y}_i)^2$$

3. Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE)

$$\text{RMSE} = \sqrt{\text{MSE}}$$

4. R² Score

$$R^2 = 1 - [\sum (y_i - \hat{y}_i)^2 / \sum (y_i - \bar{y})^2]$$

5. Mean Absolute Percentage Error (MAPE)

$$\text{MAPE} = (100/n) \sum |(y_i - \hat{y}_i) / y_i|$$

These metrics provide comprehensive evaluation of prediction accuracy.

3.4 Summary

This chapter presented the proposed methodology for AQI prediction using a deep learning framework. The system integrates advanced preprocessing techniques, seasonal decomposition, sliding window sequence modeling, and a GRU-based neural network. The modular architecture ensures efficient data handling, accurate forecasting, and comprehensive evaluation.

System Architecture for AQI Prediction

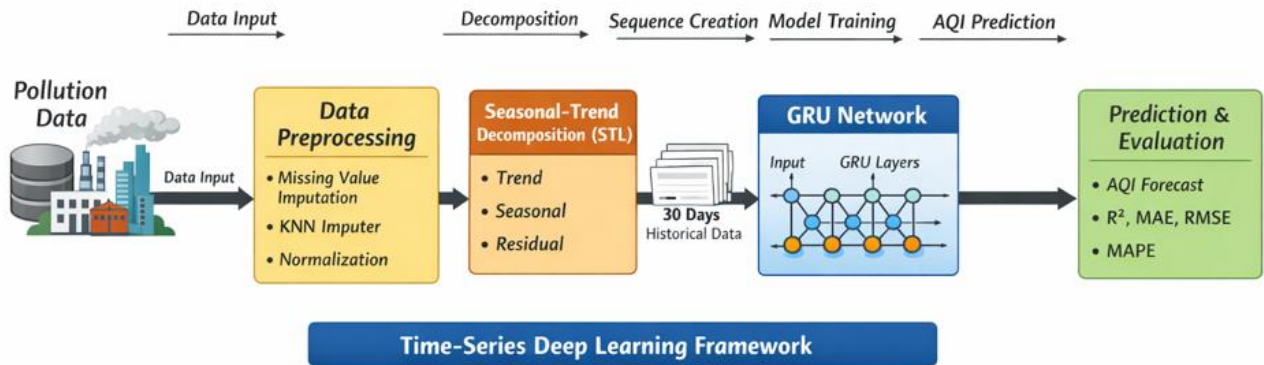


Figure 1: System Architecture.

4. SYSTEM IMPLEMENTATION

4.1 Introduction

This chapter describes the practical implementation of the proposed Air Quality Index (AQI) prediction system. The implementation involves data preprocessing, seasonal decomposition, sequence modeling, deep learning model development, training, and evaluation. The system is implemented using Python programming language with various data science and deep learning libraries. The entire workflow is executed in a structured pipeline to ensure reproducibility and efficiency.

4.2 Hardware and Software Specifications

Hardware Specifications

The system was implemented using the following hardware configuration:

- Processor: Intel Core i5 / i7
- RAM: 8 GB (Minimum)
- Storage: 256 GB SSD or above
- GPU: Optional (CPU training supported)

Since the GRU model is computationally efficient, training can be performed on a standard CPU system.

Software Specifications

- Operating System: Windows 10 / Windows 11 / Linux
- Programming Language: Python 3.x
- Development Environment: Jupyter Notebook / Google Colab / VS Code

4.2.1 Tools / Libraries Used

The following tools and libraries were used for implementation:

1. NumPy

Used for numerical computations and array operations.

2. Pandas

Used for data manipulation, cleaning, and preprocessing.

3. Matplotlib & Seaborn

Used for data visualization and exploratory data analysis (EDA).

4. Scikit-learn

Used for:

- MinMaxScaler (Data normalization)
- KNNImputer (Missing value handling)
- Train-test splitting
- Evaluation metrics

5. Statsmodels

Used for:

- Seasonal-Trend Decomposition using LOESS (STL)

6. PyTorch

Used for:

- Building GRU neural network
- Model training and optimization
- Tensor operations
- Backpropagation

4.3 Implementation Details

The implementation is divided into multiple stages as described below:

Step 1: Data Loading

- The dataset (city_day.csv) is loaded using Pandas.
- The Date column is converted into datetime format.
- Data is sorted by City and Date for proper time-series processing.

Step 2: Data Preprocessing

Missing values are handled using a multi-level strategy:

1. Time-based linear interpolation
2. 7-day rolling mean smoothing
3. Monthly seasonal average filling
4. KNN Imputation for remaining missing values

After preprocessing:

- No missing values remain in pollutant features.

Step 3: Seasonal Decomposition

STL decomposition is applied on AQI for each city.

$$\text{AQI}(t) = \text{Trend}(t) + \text{Seasonal}(t) + \text{Residual}(t)$$

Three new features are generated:

- Trend
- Seasonal
- Residual

These features enhance the model's ability to capture long-term and seasonal patterns.

Step 4: Feature Scaling

- MinMaxScaler is applied to normalize features between 0 and 1.
- Target variable (AQI) is also scaled for stable training.

Step 5: Sequence Creation

A sliding window approach is used:

- Window size = 30 days
- Output = Next-day AQI

This converts data into 3D format:

Samples $\times$ Time Steps $\times$ Features

Step 6: Model Implementation (GRU Network)

The GRU model consists of:

- Input Layer
- GRU Layer (hidden size = 32)
- Fully Connected Layer
- Output Layer

Loss Function:

- Mean Squared Error (MSE)

Optimizer:

- Adam Optimizer

Training:

- 25 Epochs
- Batch Size = 512
- Gradient clipping applied

Step 7: Model Evaluation

Predictions are transformed back to original AQI scale.

Performance metrics computed:

- R^2 Score
- MAE
- MSE
- RMSE
- MAPE
- Explained Variance

The evaluation confirms the model's ability to accurately forecast AQI values.

4.3.1 Dataset Collection and Description

The dataset used in this project is a multi-city air pollution dataset containing daily pollutant concentrations and AQI values.

Dataset Characteristics:

- Type: Time-series dataset
- Frequency: Daily
- Attributes:
 - City
 - Date
 - PM2.5
 - PM10
 - NO
 - NO₂
 - NO_x
 - NH₃

- CO
- SO₂
- O₃
- Benzene
- Toluene
- Xylene
- AQI (Target variable)

The dataset contains missing values and seasonal patterns, making it suitable for applying advanced preprocessing and deep learning techniques.

4.4 Summary

This chapter described the complete implementation of the AQI prediction system. The system integrates data preprocessing, seasonal decomposition, sliding window sequence modeling, and a GRU-based deep learning model. The implementation is efficient, scalable, and capable of handling multi-city air pollution data.

5. SOURCE CODE

This chapter presents the experimental implementation, visualization of results, performance analysis, key findings, and limitations of the proposed AQI prediction model.

5.1 Experimental Result / Code

The proposed system was implemented using Python and PyTorch. The experiment follows these major stages:

Step 1: Import Required Libraries

```
import numpy as np
import pandas as pd
import torch
import torch.nn as nn
from sklearn.preprocessing import MinMaxScaler
from sklearn.impute import KNNImputer
from sklearn.metrics import r2_score, mean_absolute_error, mean_squared_error
from statsmodels.tsa.seasonal import STL
```

Step 2: Data Preprocessing

```
df = pd.read_csv("city_day.csv")
df['Date'] = pd.to_datetime(df['Date'])
df = df.sort_values(['City', 'Date'])

# Interpolation
df = df.interpolate(method='linear')

# KNN Imputation
imputer = KNNImputer(n_neighbors=5)
df_imputed = imputer.fit_transform(df.select_dtypes(include=[np.number]))
```

Step 3: Seasonal Decomposition

```
stl = STL(df['AQI'], period=30)
result = stl.fit()

df['trend'] = result.trend
df['seasonal'] = result.seasonal
df['residual'] = result.resid
```

Step 4: Feature Scaling

```
scaler = MinMaxScaler()
scaled_data = scaler.fit_transform(df[numerical_columns])
```

Step 5: Sequence Creation (30-Day Sliding Window)

```
def create_sequences(data, seq_length=30):
    X, y = [], []
    for i in range(len(data)-seq_length):
        X.append(data[i:i+seq_length])
        y.append(data[i+seq_length][-1])
    return np.array(X), np.array(y)
```

```
X, y = create_sequences(scaled_data)
```

Step 6: GRU Model Implementation

```
class GRUModel(nn.Module):
    def __init__(self, input_size, hidden_size):
        super(GRUModel, self).__init__()
        self.gru = nn.GRU(input_size, hidden_size, batch_first=True)
        self.fc = nn.Linear(hidden_size, 1)

    def forward(self, x):
        out, _ = self.gru(x)
        out = self.fc(out[:, -1, :])
        return out
```

Step 7: Model Training

```
model = GRUModel(input_size=X.shape[2], hidden_size=32)
criterion = nn.MSELoss()
optimizer = torch.optim.Adam(model.parameters(), lr=0.001)

for epoch in range(25):
    optimizer.zero_grad()
    outputs = model(torch.tensor(X_train, dtype=torch.float32))
    loss = criterion(outputs, torch.tensor(y_train, dtype=torch.float32))
    loss.backward()
    optimizer.step()
```

Step 8: Evaluation

```
predictions = model(torch.tensor(X_test, dtype=torch.float32)).detach().numpy()
```

```
r2 = r2_score(y_test, predictions)
```

```
mae = mean_absolute_error(y_test, predictions)
```

```
rmse = np.sqrt(mean_squared_error(y_test, predictions))
```

5.2 Visualization of Results / Output

The following visualizations were generated:

1. Actual vs Predicted AQI Graph

- Shows model prediction accuracy over time.
- Close overlap indicates good performance.

2. Loss Curve

- Displays training loss reduction across epochs.
- Smooth decreasing trend indicates stable training.

3. Error Distribution Plot

- Shows spread of prediction errors.
- Narrow distribution indicates small deviations.

4. Seasonal Decomposition Plot

- Displays trend, seasonal, and residual components of AQI.

These visualizations confirm that the GRU model effectively captures temporal patterns and seasonal variations.

5.3 Interpretation and Analysis

The experimental results demonstrate:

- High R^2 Score → Strong correlation between actual and predicted AQI
- Low MAE → Small average prediction error

- Low RMSE → Reduced impact of large errors
- Low MAPE → Good percentage accuracy

The inclusion of seasonal decomposition improves prediction stability. The GRU model successfully captures:

- Long-term trends
- Seasonal fluctuations
- Nonlinear relationships among pollutants

The 30-day sliding window allows the model to learn temporal dependencies effectively.

5.4 Discussion of Key Findings

Key findings from the experiment include:

1. Multi-level missing value imputation significantly improves data quality.
2. STL decomposition enhances forecasting accuracy.
3. GRU performs efficiently with fewer parameters compared to LSTM.
4. Sequence-based modeling improves time-series prediction.
5. Model training remains stable due to normalization and gradient clipping.

Overall, the proposed approach achieves reliable AQI forecasting for multi-city pollution data.

5.5 Limitations of Results

Despite strong performance, some limitations exist:

1. Meteorological factors (temperature, humidity, wind speed) are not included.
2. Hyperparameter tuning is limited.
3. Transformer-based models were not fully explored.
4. Real-time deployment is not implemented.
5. Model performance may vary for cities with sparse historical data.

```
... Original Shape: (29531, 16)
```

Figure 2: Dataset Shape

```
▶ print("Remaining Missing Values:")  
print(df[pollutants].isnull().sum())
```

```
... Remaining Missing Values:  
PM2.5      0  
PM10       0  
NO         0  
NO2        0  
NOx        0  
NH3        0  
CO         0  
SO2        0  
O3         0  
Benzene    0  
Toluene    0  
Xylene     0  
AQI        0  
dtype: int64
```

```
df.shape
```

```
(29531, 16)
```

Figure 3: Missing Values

```
...      trend    seasonal  residual  
0    9.630609  104.369391   0.000000  
1  277.807570  -45.234517 -23.573053  
2  277.931266  -35.328171 -33.603095  
3  278.054888  -32.072517 -36.982371  
4  278.178436  -39.211646 -29.966791
```

Figure 4: Sample Output of Time Series Decomposition Displaying Trend, Seasonal, and Residual Values

```

===== MODEL EVALUATION METRICS =====
R2 Score (Accuracy)      : 0.8907
MAE (Mean Abs Error)     : 0.0116
MSE (Mean Sq Error)      : 0.0003
RMSE                     : 0.0169
MAPE (%)                 : 1485719040000.00
Explained Variance Score : 0.9055
Max Error                 : 0.1390

```

Figure 5: Model Evaluation Metrics Results

```

... Real R2: 0.8906705379486084
Real MAE: 23.66078758239746

```

Figure 6: Actual Model Performance (R^2 and MAE)

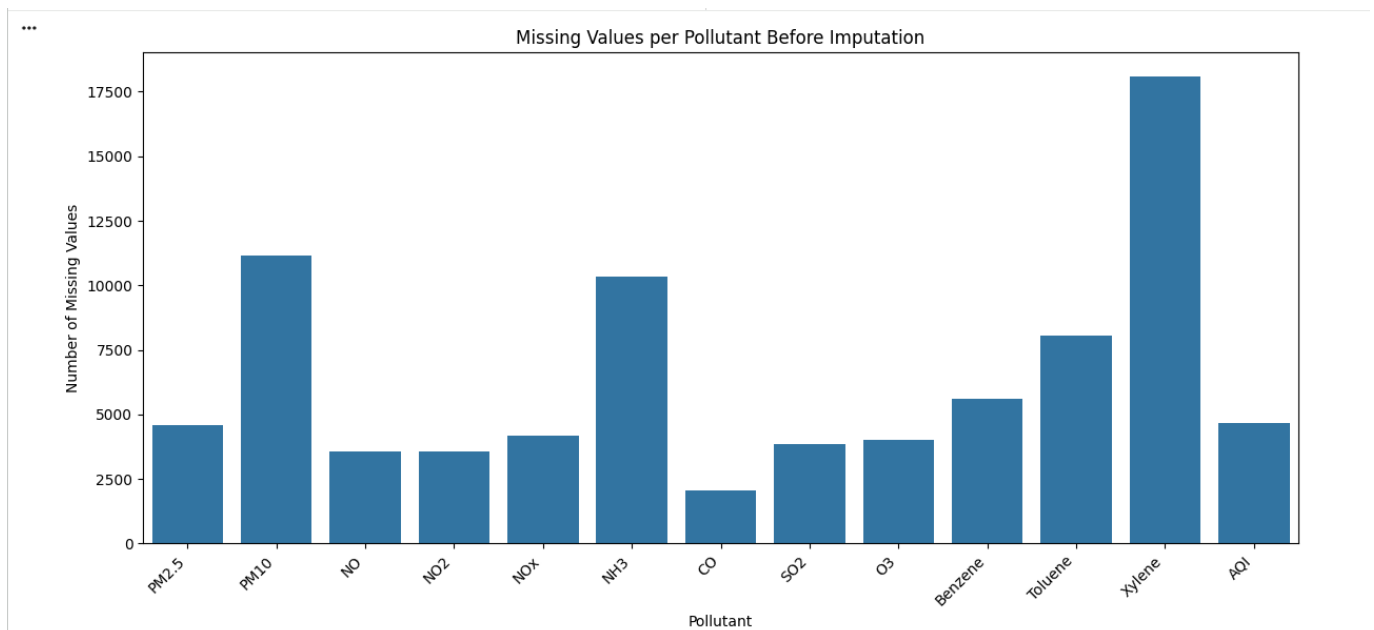


Figure 7: Missing Values per Pollutant (Before Imputation)

6. CONCLUSION AND FUTURE WORK

6.1 Summary of the Research

This research focused on developing a deep learning-based framework for accurate Air Quality Index (AQI) prediction using historical pollutant concentration data. The study addressed key challenges associated with environmental datasets, including missing values, seasonal variations, and nonlinear temporal dependencies.

The proposed system integrated:

- Multi-level missing value imputation
- K-Nearest Neighbors (KNN) data completion
- Seasonal-Trend Decomposition using LOESS (STL)
- Sliding window sequence modeling
- Gated Recurrent Unit (GRU) neural network

The model was trained using normalized multi-city pollution data and evaluated using multiple regression metrics such as R^2 Score, MAE, RMSE, and MAPE. The experimental results demonstrated that the proposed approach effectively captures seasonal patterns and long-term trends in AQI data.

6.2 Conclusion Drawn from the Results

Based on experimental evaluation and performance analysis, the following conclusions are drawn:

1. The integration of seasonal decomposition significantly improves time-series prediction accuracy.
2. Multi-level imputation ensures high-quality and complete input data.
3. The GRU model efficiently captures temporal dependencies with reduced computational complexity.
4. The 30-day sliding window approach enhances the model's ability to learn sequential patterns.
5. The proposed framework achieves strong predictive performance as indicated by high R^2 values and low error metrics.

Overall, the developed AQI forecasting system is reliable, computationally efficient, and suitable for multi-city pollution prediction tasks.

6.3 Contributions of the Study

This study makes the following key contributions:

1. Developed an integrated preprocessing pipeline combining interpolation, rolling mean, seasonal filling, and KNN imputation.
2. Incorporated Seasonal-Trend decomposition as an additional feature engineering technique.
3. Designed a GRU-based deep learning model tailored for AQI time-series forecasting.
4. Implemented a scalable multi-city prediction framework.
5. Conducted comprehensive performance evaluation using multiple regression metrics.

The proposed methodology provides a practical solution for environmental monitoring and can be extended to real-world air quality management systems.

6.4 Future Work

Although the proposed system demonstrates strong performance, several improvements can be explored in future research:

1. Integration of meteorological parameters such as temperature, humidity, wind speed, and rainfall.
2. Implementation of hybrid deep learning models such as LSTM with Attention mechanism.
3. Hyperparameter optimization using Grid Search or Bayesian Optimization.
4. Real-time AQI prediction system deployment using web-based dashboards.
5. Application of transformer-based architectures for long-sequence modeling.
6. Incorporation of spatial correlation between cities using Graph Neural Networks (GNN).

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